FACULTY SEMINAR · DAVID ECCLES SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

AI and Business Schools: What Changes for Our Students, and for Us

October 22, 2026 · 9–11 AM · Garff Auditorium · Kerry Back, Rice Business

Program

Intro — **Introduction: what our students will be hired for**

Analytical skills: necessary, no longer differentiating · What matters most: knowing which analysis to run and when an analysis is wrong, and the judgment to go from analysis to action · The teaching consequence: more cases, more defending positions out loud

1 — **Onboarding students with AI: what each student needs to know**

What AI can do and build with code · How AI goes wrong, how to mitigate, and how to evaluate · Standing instructions and reusable workflows (skills and AGENTS.md) · AI agent = model + tools + harness, and each is a choice · Use AI as a tutor · Security risks

2 — **Teaching analytics with AI**

Whiteboard to AI to cold calling with screen sharing · What to do when we still want Excel · Interactive HTML apps instead · How much deeper we can go now

3 — **Using AI to assist with teaching**

Using AI to create exercises, cases, and slide decks · Interactive HTML apps for demonstrations · Building AI tutors · Deploying tools · FERPA: de-identifying student data

4 — **What AI tools should we provide?**

Gemini Notebook · Claude Code · VS Code / Academic Studio · AI on a budget

Q&A — **Closing discussion and Q&A**

About the speaker

Kerry Back teaches asset pricing theory to PhD students in the Jones School and the Department of Economics at Rice, data-driven finance in the Master of Data Science program, and generative AI for finance and data management to MBA students. He also teaches a monthly online executive education course on agentic AI. Before Rice, he was on the faculties of Northwestern, Indiana, Washington University in St. Louis — where he served as Senior Associate Dean at the Olin School — and Texas A&M. He is a former editor of the Review of Financial Studies and of Finance & Stochastics, a former associate editor of the Journal of Finance, and the author of two textbooks. He received the Financial Management Association's Innovation in Teaching Award in 2023 and 2025, and the Jones School's PhD Mentoring Award in 2024 and 2026.